ENGLISH C2 · ANSWER KEY

Sequence of tenses and selective backshift

Solutions and feedback for the Sequence of tenses and selective backshift in English C2 exercise workbook.

THIS DOCUMENT

Answer key

Model answers and concise grammar explanations for every stage in the separate exercise workbook.

RECOMMENDED USE

Keep the three-document system together

Correct one stage at a time. Explain the rule aloud before marking an answer as secure.

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01	02	03	04
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STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Recognition in context

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

A1

The witness said that she had left before midnight.

Backshifted report is the best match because an earlier embedded event viewed from a past report point.

A2

The report stated that the river is highly vulnerable to flooding.

Current-validity retention is the best match because a proposition presented as still valid now.

A3

The spokesperson claimed that the system was entirely secure.

Deliberate distancing is the best match because a reported claim from which the writer maintains distance.

A4

an earlier embedded event viewed from a past report point

The Backshifted report pattern communicates an earlier embedded event viewed from a past report point.

A5

a proposition presented as still valid now

The Current-validity retention pattern communicates a proposition presented as still valid now.

A6

a reported claim from which the writer maintains distance

The Deliberate distancing pattern communicates a reported claim from which the writer maintains distance.

Form and function

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

B1

Backshifted report / an earlier embedded event viewed from a past report point

The structure belongs to the Backshifted report pattern. Its communicative purpose is an earlier embedded event viewed from a past report point.

B2

Current-validity retention / a proposition presented as still valid now

The structure belongs to the Current-validity retention pattern. Its communicative purpose is a proposition presented as still valid now.

B3

Deliberate distancing / a reported claim from which the writer maintains distance

The structure belongs to the Deliberate distancing pattern. Its communicative purpose is a reported claim from which the writer maintains distance.

Guided discourse choices

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

C1

The witness said that she had left before midnight.

Backshifted report: past reporting verb + past/perfect embedded tense.

C2

The report stated that the river is highly vulnerable to flooding.

Current-validity retention: past reporting verb + present tense.

C3

The spokesperson claimed that the system was entirely secure.

Deliberate distancing: backshift to mark reduced commitment.

C4

The witness said that she had left before midnight.

Backshifted report: past reporting verb + past/perfect embedded tense.

C5

The report stated that the river is highly vulnerable to flooding.

Current-validity retention: past reporting verb + present tense.

C6

The spokesperson claimed that the system was entirely secure.

Deliberate distancing: backshift to mark reduced commitment.

Open reconstruction

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

D1

had left

Backshifted report requires “had left” in this model. past reporting verb + past/perfect embedded tense.

D2

river is highly vulnerable

Current-validity retention requires “river is highly vulnerable” in this model. past reporting verb + present tense.

D3

claimed that the system was

Deliberate distancing requires “claimed that the system was” in this model. backshift to mark reduced commitment.

D4

past reporting verb + past/perfect embedded tense

Backshifted report is built as past reporting verb + past/perfect embedded tense.

D5

past reporting verb + present tense

Current-validity retention is built as past reporting verb + present tense.

Controlled transformation

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

E1

The witness said that she had left before midnight.

past reporting verb + past/perfect embedded tense. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended backshifted report effect.

E2

The report stated that the river is highly vulnerable to flooding.

past reporting verb + present tense. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended current-validity retention effect.

E3

The spokesperson claimed that the system was entirely secure.

backshift to mark reduced commitment. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended deliberate distancing effect.

E4

The witness said that she had left before midnight.

past reporting verb + past/perfect embedded tense. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended backshifted report effect.

Communicative production

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

F1

The witness said that she had left before midnight. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses past reporting verb + past/perfect embedded tense accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

F2

The report stated that the river is highly vulnerable to flooding. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses past reporting verb + present tense accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

F3

The spokesperson claimed that the system was entirely secure. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses backshift to mark reduced commitment accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

07 · FEEDBACK

Diagnose the pattern, not only the score

Use this page to decide what to revisit in the complete guide.

CHECK · TRIGGER OR CONTEXT

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · AUXILIARY OR STRUCTURAL CHOICE

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · MAIN VERB OR CLAUSE FORM

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · MEANING AND REGISTER

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

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RETRIEVAL

Final self-check

Complete these prompts without reopening the guide.